

Haochen Ni

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Education

University College London

BSc Economics – Predicted First Class Honours

Sep 2024 – Jun 2027

Relevant Modules

Mathematics: Real Analysis (91.1), Advanced Linear Algebra (88.1), Metric Spaces.

Economics: Microeconomics (78.4), Econometrics (74.9), Macroeconomics.

Forthcoming: Multivariable Analysis, Game Theory, Information Economics, Industrial Organisation.

Research Interests: Microeconomic Theory, Game Theory, Information Economics, Information Design.

Research Papers

Partial Universalisation in Threshold Public Goods: Actions to Inclinations

Working Paper, 2026

- Developed a theory of partial Kantian reasoning in finite threshold public-good environments, where contemplated strategies are probabilistically linked to the behaviour of like-minded agents.
- Established a collective pivotality representation: the pure-contribution premium equals the probability that the contribution-oriented counterfactual reaches the provision threshold while the abstention-oriented does not.
- Proved that collective pivotality is strictly single-peaked in background cooperation for every admissible finite threshold, generating a bounded contribution region under intermediate contribution costs.
- Extended the model from pure commitments to endogenous contribution inclinations and, for every admissible group size and threshold, identified a non-empty open parameter region with a unique strict interior optimum.
- Showed that pure abstention can be preferred to pure contribution even when a strictly positive interior contribution inclination is optimal, separating observed abstention from the absence of cooperative motivation.

A Structural Theory of the Willingness-to-Pay Gap: Valuation and Behaviour in Climate Mitigation

UCL Journal of Economics, 2026

- Developed a micro-founded model distinguishing stated willingness to pay as a welfare-based compensating-variation object from actual contribution as an optimisation-based behavioural choice.
- Showed that a value-action wedge can arise under stable preferences and rational choice because welfare valuation and contribution behaviour are governed by different economic conditions.
- Analysed how altruism, warm-glow, social image, and observability affect the size of the wedge, and developed a limited-attention interpretation under which prompts emphasising budgets and opportunity costs can narrow the observed gap without changing preferences.

Research Experience

Research Assistant – Empirical IO

Jun 2026 – Present

Imperial College London, London, UK

- Assisted an empirical industrial organisation project on Chinese pharmaceutical markets, focusing on how volume-based procurement affects firm incentives and substitution across drug categories.
- Constructed a preliminary Yaodu-Cortellis company-matching workflow using name standardisation, token-based candidate generation, fuzzy matching, LLM-assisted screening, and manual auditing.
- Researched volume-based procurement, pharmaceutical pricing, and Chinese patent medicines, developing a proposal on whether procurement pressure on chemical drugs induces substitution toward Chinese patent medicines.
- Applied principal-agent and credence-goods frameworks to analyse incentive and informational frictions among governments, hospitals, and pharmaceutical firms.

Academic Engagement

- Presented the willingness to pay project at the UCL Explore Econ 2026.
- Regular attendance at UCL Centre for Theoretical and Behavioural Economics (THEBES) seminars.

Skills & Interests

Technical Skills: Python, Stata, LaTeX, Excel, Mathematica.

Language: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate).

Societies: UCL Economists' Society, UCL Philosophy Society, UCL Japan Society.